

The History Department

YEAR 7 SCHEME OF WORK (2026-2027)

Curriculum Planning & Lesson Companion

Key Stage 3 Curriculum Intent & Pedagogical Architecture

1. Curriculum Rationale & Local Maritime Heritage

Our Key Stage 3 history curriculum is intentionally constructed to link national and global historical narratives with the distinctive maritime geography and lived environment of The History Portal pupils. From the industrial revolution of the Fareham ironmaster (Henry Cort at Funtley) to the strategic supremacy of Portsmouth Royal Dockyard and the profound sacrifices recorded on the Stubbington village war memorials, history is made tangible, relevant, and deeply rooted in our coastal community.

2. Disciplinary Progression & Historical Enquiry

Across Years 7, 8, and 9, disciplinary thinking progresses sequentially to secure the foundational skills required for GCSE excellence:

- **Chronological Rigour & Global Encounters:** De-centering traditional anglocentric narratives by examining early global trade, Indigenous perspectives in Australia, and African resistance to the Transatlantic Slave Trade alongside British social transformations.
- **Causation & Consequence:** Moving from simple direct triggers in Year 7 to evaluating multi-tiered, long-term geopolitical catalysts (e.g. European alliance systems, naval arms races).
- **Source Utility & Forensic Evidence:** Progressing from basic comprehension to rigorous interrogation of provenance, evaluating authorial motive, audience, and historical reliability.
- **Historiographical Debate:** Engaging pupils with active academic debates (e.g., assessing the Magna Carta, or challenging the 'Lions led by Donkeys' narrative of the Great War) grounded in historical evidence.

3. Adaptive Teaching, Dual Coding & Inclusion

Pupils work through bespoke printed A4 workbooks closely paired with our digital learning portal. Standardized PEE/PEEL Structure Strips, Causal Connective Banks, consistent dual coding, and digital accessibility features offload working memory, ensuring all SEND and lower-attaining pupils achieve ambitious historical progress with zero cognitive overload.

KS3: Water and Sanitation Through Time

Year 7 | Why did it take so long to clean up Britain?

Lesson Number & Title	Learning Objectives & Enquiry	Curriculum Rigour: Evidence, Debate & Assessment
Lesson 1 How much progress did the Romans make in public health?	• Describe the key features of Roman public health infrastructure, including aqueducts, bathhouses, and sewers • Explain how the Roman Empire's centralised power enabled large-scale public health projects • Evaluate the significance of Roman public health by assessing whether it represented genuine medical understanding or imperial prestige	 PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS: Housesteads Fort Roman communal latrines (Hadrian's Wall); Seneca's moral treatise on Roman baths; Fishbourne Roman Palace mosaics  DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS: Roman engineering triumphalism vs lived public health reality: lead piping & parasite transmission  CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT: Write a PEEL paragraph explaining how the Romans tried to keep their towns clean.

Lesson Number & Title	Learning Objectives & Enquiry	Curriculum Rigour: Evidence, Debate & Assessment
Lesson 2 Why did public health decline during the Middle Ages?	- Explain how the collapse of Roman imperial power led to the decline of organised public health systems - Describe the role of the medieval Church in shaping attitudes to disease and sanitation - Assess the significance of the Black Death (1348) as a turning point in medieval public health	 PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS: Canterbury Cathedral Waterworks Plan (c. 1165); City of London Sanitary Ordinance of 1357; Monastic reredorter latrine architecture  DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS: Medieval hygiene myths: Religious purity and monastic engineering vs urban municipal paralysis  CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT: Write a PEEL paragraph explaining why public health in towns got worse during the Middle Ages.
Lesson 3 To what extent did towns become filthier during the Early Modern period?	- Describe the public health challenges caused by rapid urbanisation in Early Modern towns - Explain why governments failed to act despite growing evidence of poor sanitation - Evaluate the extent to which continuity, rather than change, defined public health between 1500 and 1750	 PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS: Sir John Harington's 1596 'Ajax' Toilet Diagram; Samuel Pepys' 1660 Diary on cellar privies; The Cowdray Engraving of Tudor Portsmouth (1545)  DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS: Laissez-faire policy debate & Roy Porter on early modern infrastructure limits; technological innovation vs municipal failure  CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT: Write a PEEL paragraph explaining why the growth of towns (urbanisation) made public health worse in the Early Modern period.
Lesson 4 How did the Industrial Revolution lead to a public health crisis?	- Explain how industrialisation and mass migration to cities created unprecedented public health crises - Describe the role of key individuals (John Snow, Edwin Chadwick) in challenging existing beliefs about disease - Analyse the significance of the 1848 Public Health Act as an example of government intervention driven by causation evidence	 PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS: Chadwick's 1842 Report on the Sanitary Condition of the Labouring Population; Dr John Snow's Broad Street Cholera Spot Map (1854); Portsmouth cholera burial registers  DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS: Industrial urbanisation: Miasma theory vs early contagionist epidemiology; laissez-faire vs state health intervention  CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT: Write a PEEL paragraph explaining why John Snow's discovery at the Broad Street pump was a turning point.
Lesson 5 Why did it take the 'Great Stink' to finally clean up Britain's streets?	- Explain why it took Parliament so long to act on public health reform despite mounting evidence - Describe how the 'Great Stink' of 1858 became a turning point that forced government action - Evaluate the significance of Joseph Bazalgette's sewer system as a landmark of change in public health	 PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS: Punch Cartoon 'The Silent Highwayman' (1858 Great Stink); Bazalgette's Victorian intercepting sewer blueprints (1859–1865); Eastney Beam Engine Pumping Station, Portsmouth: Civic Sanitation Masterpiece (1887)  DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS: The Great Stink of 1858: Parliamentary self-interest and physical stench vs municipal laissez-faire ideology  CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT: Write a PEEL paragraph explaining how Joseph Bazalgette's sewers improved public health in London.
Lesson 6 End of Unit Assessment: Cholera Investigation	- Evaluate how Dr John Snow used map data and scientific deduction to prove cholera was waterborne in 1854. - Explain the shift from laissez-faire government attitudes to compulsory state intervention in British public health. - Produce a structured 8-mark explanation assessing the significance of Victorian sanitation reforms.	 PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS: Dr John Snow's 1854 Broad Street Cholera Spot Map; Soho mortality records & Eley Brothers percussion cap factory logs  DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS: Snow's empirical epidemiological mapping vs the entrenched medical establishment and Board of Health  CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT: Explain the significance of John Snow's discovery during the 1854 Broad Street Cholera outbreak. (8 marks)

Unit Key Vocabulary: Cholera • Miasma Theory • Laissez-Faire • Cesspit • Back-to-back housing • Public Health Act 1848 • Public Health Act 1875 • Broad Street Pump • The Great Stink • Sewage System • Edwin Chadwick • John Snow • Joseph Bazalgette • Industrial Revolution

Medieval England: 1066–1485

Year 7 | How was power won, maintained, and lost in Medieval England?

Lesson Number & Title	Learning Objectives & Enquiry	Curriculum Rigour: Evidence, Debate & Assessment
Lesson 1 1066 & The Battle of Hastings: Why did William win?	- Describe the three rival claims to the English throne in 1066 and assess which claimant held the strongest legal claim. - Explain how military tactics, physical exhaustion, and battlefield leadership decided the Battle of Hastings. - Evaluate whether William won through tactical superiority or whether King Harold lost due to exhaustion and bad luck.	 PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS: Source A: The Bayeux Tapestry: King Edward the Confessor on his Deathbed (c. 1070s); Source B: The Anglo-Saxon Chronicle (Manuscript C, 1066) on the Battle of Stamford Bridge  DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS: Evaluate whether William won through tactical superiority or whether King Harold lost due to exhaustion and bad luck.  CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT: [Written Synthesis] Complete structured analytical enquiry response in pupil workbook.
Lesson 2 Castles, Terror & Domesday: How did William control England?	- Explain how William used Motte and Bailey castles as instruments of military domination and psychological terror. - Describe the Harrying of the North (1069–70) and evaluate its devastation as an example of medieval scorched-earth warfare. - Assess the role of the 1086 Domesday Book in establishing royal surveillance, fiscal control, and crushing Saxon resistance.	 PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS: Source A: The Bayeux Tapestry: Normans Constructing a Motte and Bailey Castle at Hastings (c. 1070s); Source B: Orderic Vitalis, Ecclesiastical History (c. 1120s) on the Harrying of the North  DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS: Describe the Harrying of the North and evaluate its devastation as medieval scorched-earth warfare.  CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT: [Written Synthesis] Complete structured analytical enquiry response in pupil workbook.
Lesson 3 Crown vs Church: Why did Henry II clash with Thomas Becket?	- Explain why the balance of power between the Monarchy and the Catholic Church was the central struggle of medieval government. - Describe the legal conflict over the Constitutions of Clarendon (1164) and the issue of 'criminous clerks'. - Evaluate whether Becket's murder was the inevitable result of conflicting legal systems or the personal obstinacy of two proud men.	 PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS: Source A: Contemporary Depiction of King Henry II and Chancellor Thomas Becket (12th-Century Manuscript); Source B: Clause 3 of the Constitutions of Clarendon (1164)  DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS: Evaluate whether Becket's murder resulted from institutional conflict or personal pride.  CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT: [Written Synthesis] Complete structured analytical enquiry response in pupil workbook.
Lesson 4 Magna Carta (1215): Liberty or Barons' Power Grab?	- Explain how King John's military failures in France and arbitrary taxation drove the English barons into open rebellion. - Analyse the key clauses of Magna Carta (1215), particularly Clause 39 and Clause 40, to assess the limits placed on royal power. - Evaluate the historiographical debate: was Magna Carta a selfish feudal peace treaty or the foundation stone of modern human rights?	 PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS: Source A: Roger of Wendover, Flowers of History (c. 1220s) on King John's Extortions; Source B: Clauses 12, 39, and 61 of Magna Carta (15 June 1215)  DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS: Evaluate whether Magna Carta was a selfish baronial pact or a charter of liberty.  CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT: [Written Synthesis] Complete structured analytical enquiry response in pupil workbook.
Lesson 5 Doom Paintings & Tithes: What was life like in a medieval village?	- Describe the social structure of the Three Estates and the daily economic routine of open-field farming in a medieval village. - Explain how manorial obligations, ecclesiastical tithes, and episcopal palaces like Bishop's Waltham extracted peasant wealth in Hampshire. - Evaluate how visual Church art (Doom paintings) and Latin liturgy policed peasant behavior through psychological fear of eternal damnation.	 PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS: Source A: The Luttrell Psalter: Peasants Reaping Wheat Under the Reeve's Direction (c. 1330); Source B: The Pipe Rolls of the Bishopric of Winchester for the Manor of Bishop's Waltham (c. 1210)  DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS: Evaluate how Doom paintings and fear of Hell policed peasant behavior.  CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT: [Written Synthesis] Complete structured analytical enquiry response in pupil workbook.

Lesson Number & Title	Learning Objectives & Enquiry	Curriculum Rigour: Evidence, Debate & Assessment
Lesson 6 1348: How did the Black Death shatter medieval social order?	- Describe the biological arrival and catastrophic symptoms of the Black Death (<i>Yersinia pestis</i>) in England in 1348. - Explain how the death of 30–45% of the population generated an acute labour shortage and shattered feudal obligations. - Evaluate whether the Black Death ruined medieval society or triggered a "Golden Age" for surviving English peasants.	 PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS: Source A: Henry Knighton, Chronicle of Leicester Abbey on the Black Death (1348–1349); Source B: Bishop Ralph of Shrewsbury's Emergency Letter to the Diocese of Bath and Wells (January 1349)  DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS: Evaluate whether the Black Death triggered a "Golden Age" for surviving peasants.  CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT: [Written Synthesis] Complete structured analytical enquiry response in pupil workbook.
Lesson 7 1381: Why did the Peasants revolt, and did they achieve anything?	- Explain the underlying socio-economic grievances and the immediate catalyst (the 1381 Poll Tax) that triggered the Peasants' Revolt. - Describe the explosive events of June 1381: the march on London, the storming of the Tower, and the confrontation at Smithfield. - Evaluate the outcomes of the revolt: was it an immediate bloody failure or a decisive long-term catalyst for the death of serfdom?	 PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS: Source A: Jean Froissart on the Preaching of Radical Priest John Ball (c. 1380s); Source B: The Anonimale Chronicle: The Execution of Archbishop Sudbury (1381)  DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS: Evaluate whether the Peasants' Revolt achieved anything in the long term.  CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT: [Written Synthesis] Complete structured analytical enquiry response in pupil workbook.
Lesson 8 The Wars of the Roses (1455–1485): Dynastic Bloodbath	- Explain how the mental incapacity of King Henry VI and the rise of "Bastard Feudalism" triggered the dynastic civil war. - Analyse the brutal escalation of the conflict from the bloodbath of Towton (1461) to the disappearance of the Princes in the Tower (1483). - Evaluate the significance of the Battle of Bosworth Field (1485) in terminating the Plantagenet dynasty and inaugurating Tudor rule.	 PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS: Source A: The Crowland Chronicle on the Factionalism and Weakness of Henry VI (c. 1450s); Source B: The Chronicle of the Brut on the Slaughter at the Battle of Towton (1461)  DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS: Evaluate the significance of Bosworth Field (1485) in ending the medieval era.  CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT: [Written Synthesis] Complete structured analytical enquiry response in pupil workbook.
Lesson 9 Assessment: How powerful was a medieval monarch?	- Synthesise evidence across the medieval era (1066–1485) regarding the extent and limitations of royal power. - Contrast instruments of royal strength (feudal landholding, common law, castles) against external checks (the Church, baronial revolt, peasant resistance). - Formulate a sustained, evaluative historical judgement on whether medieval kingship was inherently absolute or conditional.	 PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS: Source A: The Anglo-Saxon Chronicle Obituary of William the Conqueror (1087); Source B: Henry de Bracton, On the Laws and Customs of England (c. 1250s)  DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS: Core Disciplinary Concept: Historical Enquiry & Causal Argumentation  CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT: [Written Synthesis] Complete structured analytical enquiry response in pupil workbook.
Unit Key Vocabulary: Power • Claim • Conquest • Anglo-Saxon • Significance • Feudal system • Resistance • Propaganda • Domesday Book • Motte-and-bailey • Church • Monarchy • Martyr • Excommunication • Canon law • Magna Carta • Democracy • Parliament • Interpretation • Baron • Peasantry • Tithe • Feudalism • Serf • Strip farming • Black Death • Change • Labour shortage • Statute of Labourers • Social order • Revolt • Poll tax • Wat Tyler • Villeinage • Dynasty • Usurper • Synthesis • Evidence • Judgement		